WEATHER

CAUGHT IN EXTREMES

Adverse climate events have become the new normal in India, impacting lives, livelihoods and the economy. Why are we seeing them and what can be done?

Graphic by **NILANJAN DAS/ AI**
Compiled by **JUMANA SHAH**

The Wayanad landslides, Rajkot floods and Delhi first reeling under 50°-plus temperatures and then slammed by incessant rain—the past few months have exposed India's vulnerability to climate extremes. According to a Centre for Science and Environment (CSE) report, the country recorded such events on 318 of the 365 days in 2023, claiming 3,287 lives. There seems to have been no let-up this year as well. Rising temperatures are intensifying heat waves while erratic monsoon patterns are causing both prolonged droughts and severe flooding. India's 7,500-km coastline is increasingly threatened by cyclones and sea-level rise. A recent report, 'State of Extreme Events 2024', by IPE Global and Esri India documents these trends and identifies the hotspots across the country.

85%
of Indian districts are exposed to extreme climate events

1.47 BN
India's population estimated to be highly exposed to climate extremes by 2036

$87 BN
India's estimated annual losses due to extreme climate events

Source: *State of Extreme Events 2024 (IPE Global & Esri India), State of Environment 2024 (CSE), State of Climate report (WMO)*



HEAT WAVES

- More than 84% of Indian districts are extreme heat wave hotspots
- As per the IPCC, heat waves that occurred once in 10 years without human-caused warming are now likely to occur every 3.6 years and will be 1.5°C warmer